

Question:

A 9-month-old boy is brought to the pediatrician because he can not sit on his own without support and has involuntary movements. He was born vaginally with no complications at full term. There is no history of consanguinity among parents. On physical examination, it was noticed that he is a stunted infant with generalized hypotonia and severe generalized dystonic movements. The mother says that she has noticed the presence of orange sand in his diapers many times. Laboratory evaluation revealed elevated uric acid levels in both blood and urine. Hypoxanthine-guanine phosphoribosyltransferase is found to be deficient in his blood samples. He was prescribed an appropriate medication and sent home. The most likely mechanism of this drug is the inhibition of which of the following enzymes in addition to xanthine oxidase? Answer Choices: A. Purine nucleoside phosphorylase B. Orotate phosphoribosyltransferase C. Ribonucleotide reductase D. Dihydrofolate reductase

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> the compounds in the purine pathway have been identified as hypoxanthine, xanthine, and then uric acid. hence if uric acid is elevated it means that pathway is blocked. uric acid is also made by hypoxanthine-guanine phosphoribosyltransferase so the second reaction is likely inhibited in addition to xanthine oxidase. the compound involved in the second reaction is guanine. </think> <answer>Guanine phosphoribosyltransferase</answer>

